

**INSTRUCTIONS FOR THE PREPARATION OF
HONORS
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INTRODUCTION

Please read these instructions before you begin preparation of your thesis.

The instructions give an overview of preparing a thesis, but they cannot cover all possible formats and information. The following sets of guidelines for such things as citation of references, footnote forms and location, and bibliography are those required by the Department of Computer Science. It is therefore important that students confer with either the Honors Program Director or advisor early in their research in order to become familiar with these guidelines.

I. CONTENT AND ORGANIZATION

The word “thesis” is used in the text to refer to the Honors Report required by the Computer Science Department as partial fulfillment of the requirements for graduation with honors. The order of the listing should be observed regardless of parts which may be omitted or combined in a particular thesis.

The final submitted file should be in PDF format.

ORDER

Thesis format:
A. Title Page
B. Dedication and Acknowledgments (Optional)
C. Table of Contents
D. List of Illustrations and/or Tables (Optional)
E. List of Abbreviations (Optional)
F. Abstract
G. Introduction
H. Main Body of Text
I. References
J. Appendix (Optional)
K. Curriculum Vitae
• A separate file with at least 5 keywords, which will help a search engine locate the thesis.

DESCRIPTION

A. Title Page

The title page should include the following:

1. Thesis title centered and capitalized. Triple space and center the word “BY” followed by another triple space.
2. Author’s name centered and capitalized, followed by a double space.
3. Submission statement consisting of the following lines **centered and double spaced**:

“A *Thesis* Submitted to the Faculty of the

THE DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AT FOREST UNIVERSITY

“in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirementsor

Graduation With Honors in”

Computer Science

(insert Graduation Date [AUGUST, DECEMBER or MAY] as Month Year)

Winston-Salem, North Carolina

This should be followed with a triple space with “Approved By” centered and a double spaced.

4. This should be followed with a triple space with “Approved By” centered and a double spaced.
5. Names of Examining Committee members centered and double-spaced beginning with *(insert name)* , Advisor, then *(insert name)*, Chair of Honors Committee.

See samples on pages 10.

B. Dedication and Acknowledgments

A Dedication is optional but if included should come directly after the title page. The heading should be centered and capitalized.

Acknowledgements are also optional, but the majority of students do include this section. It is an opportunity for the student to recognize and express appreciation to those who encouraged and assisted them in their graduate education and research. The heading should be centered and capitalized.

C. Table of Contents

This is required and the heading should be centered and capitalized. The table of contents should outline major sections or chapter headings with corresponding page numbers. Pages prior to the table of contents

should not be listed but all sections or chapters following it must be included, such as appendices and curriculum vitae. Sub-headings can be broken down under the section or chapter, but this is not required. All headings should be worded identically to those used in the text.

D. List of Illustrations and Tables (Optional)

The List of Illustrations and Tables heading should be centered and capitalized. This section is required but can be divided into two different lists. If combined (preferable), the listing should run consecutively noting tables and figures as they appear in the text (divided by chapter). All illustrations and tables must have a legend.

E. List of Abbreviations (Optional)

The List of Abbreviations heading should be centered and capitalized. The abbreviations should be arranged alphabetically.

F. Abstract

The Abstract heading should be centered and capitalized. The abstract should summarize the thesis, including the research problem, methods, and conclusions. It should be limited to 200 words.

G. Introduction

The Introduction should prepare the reader for what follows by stating the specific problem or question to be studied and the research strategy used. It may delineate the boundaries of the problem or question and the limitations of the topic, and it may review studies pertinent to the thesis.

H. Main Body of Text

Depending on the field of study, the main body may be organized into sections on Methods, Results, and Conclusion or Discussion, or into chapters appropriate to the study with, for example, each chapter covering a specific aspect or major component of the topic. The important thing is to have an overall organization which suits the work. Each section or chapter should begin on a new page and should exactly reflect the title listed in the Table of Contents.

Submitted or Published Manuscripts

If the student has submitted, had accepted, or published one or more papers pertinent to the subject of the thesis, the paper(s) may be incorporated into the thesis, as long as the student had the major role in the preparation of the manuscript and has the right to

include the paper(s). Portions of papers representing work either not done by the student or used as part of another thesis should be identified clearly and, if permissible, placed in an appendix.

Theses including papers submitted, accepted, or published are subject to the same principles of consistency. However, the form for literature citations, table presentations, references, etc. may conform to the style required by the publishing journal.

Generally, each paper constitutes a chapter of the thesis. A statement should be included on the title page of the chapter stating that stylistic variations result from the demands of the journal to which the paper was submitted, accepted, or published. In the case of multiple authorship, the student should indicate the portion of the work for which he or she is responsible.

It is important to clearly state the status of each manuscript submitted, accepted, and published. This can be done in the Table of Contents by including a statement that the manuscript has been submitted, accepted, or published.

Theses containing papers already published or accepted for publication must be accompanied by letters of permission or denial of permission concerning copyright, when applicable. Such letters should be included as an appendix to the thesis. Many publishers automatically grant authors the right to include papers as thesis chapters. It is the student's responsibility to confirm the right to republish prior to inclusion. One example is Academic Press which no longer requires authors to obtain permission in the following cases: 1) to use original figures or tables in future works; 2) to make copies of papers for classroom teaching; and 3) to include papers as part of the thesis. Students are responsible for determining whether additional permission from copyright holders is required.

I. References

The Reference section should begin on a new page and include every book, article, thesis, abstract, videotape, website, etc. mentioned in the thesis with complete publishing information. Other sources, such as interviews, are also listed with appropriate information about when and where they took place. The references can be cited either alphabetically or as they are cited in the text, just maintain consistency throughout. The library has guidelines for citing references including on-line material at <http://zsr.wfu.edu/research/guides/citation.html>.

J. Appendix (Optional)

The appendix could include any supplementary materials that support or are relevant to the thesis, but which have no logical or appropriate place within the body of the text. This should begin on a separate page and be numbered consecutively with the entire document.

K. Curriculum Vitae

The Curriculum Vitae, also called Scholastic Vita, or simply Vita, should begin on a separate page. This section would contain the student's educational background, academic awards, honors, memberships in professional organizations, publications, presentations, and other pertinent information. This statement should be presented in outline form.

II. DOCUMENT FORMAT

PRESENTATION

The thesis should be uniformly arranged and error free.

A. Page Layout

The thesis should have uniform margins as follows:

1.0"	Top Margin
1.0"	Bottom Margin
1.5"	Left Margin
1.0"	Right Margin

B. Spacing

The text of a thesis should be double-spaced throughout. The manuscript will look more professional if the right margin is justified, although this is not a requirement. Paragraphs can begin with the first line indented or you may double space between paragraphs, as long as you are consistent.

C. Font

Font type should be professional looking; suggestions would be Times Roman or Arial. The size should be either 11 or 12 and should remain consistent throughout the document.

D. Pagination

All pages of the thesis are numbered **EXCEPT** the title page. The preferred method for page numbering is centered at the bottom of the page but numbered in the top right corner is also acceptable. If you use the bottom centered method, the footer would be placed at .5". If you use the top right corner, the header would be placed at .5" and the text would begin at 1.0". If your document contains landscape pages, the page number should appear in the same position as the rest of the document.

Roman numbers are used on the pages preceding chapter one. The first number would be used on the page immediately following the title page and the number would be ii. Arabic numerals begin with chapter one and includes the text, illustrations, tables, through to the Curriculum Vitae.

E. Headings

All headings must be formatted consistently throughout the thesis. Formatting choices would include either centered with solid capitals or centered with both capitals and lower case underscored.

F. Illustrations and Tables

Illustrations and tables including photographs are used to enhance the thesis and must be referenced in the text. The size will determine where it is placed. If it is small, it can be placed on the page with the text above/below as reference. Larger illustrations or tables can be placed on the page following the first point of reference. Large items must be reduced to fit the page size. Using landscape orientation is also an option.

Roman numerals should be used for tables (Table I, Table II, etc.) and Arabic numerals for other illustrations (Figure 1, Figure 2, Chart 1, Chart 2 etc.). Illustrations pages must be paginated according to the format used in the text. All copyright laws must be observed for illustrations as well as text.

III. COPYRIGHT

Standard citation of others' copyrighted works does not require permission from the copyright holder prior to use in theses. The republication of tables, charts, images, etc. from previously published works, authored by others or the student, does require permission from the copyright holder. Although most publishers automatically grant student authors the right to republish their own accepted or published work(s) as part of theses, confirmation of that right should be obtained prior to inclusion.

Copyright is automatically vested with authors as theses are written and saved in a fixed format. Inclusion of the copyright notice is necessary if the student wishes to file for official copyright registration (e.g., Copyright John Doe 2010; it must appear on the title page or the page immediately following). The majority of theses probably do not require official copyright registration. A student may wish to consult with the advisor on this matter.

IV. SUBMISSION

Students should check with the Department and advisors regarding submission requirements..

Some helpful links:

<http://zsr.wfu.edu/research/guides/citation.html>

<http://zsr.wfu.edu/research/guides/copyright/#zsrcopy>

Sample Title Page for Honors Thesis

CENTERED ON PAGE

PROCESSES AND CONCURRENCY IN OPERATING SYSTEMS

BY

DANIEL RITCHIE

A Thesis Submitted to the Faculty of the
DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AT WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY

in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for

Graduation with Honors in

Computer Science

May 2023

Winston-Salem, North Carolina

Approved By:

George Jobs, Ph.D., Advisor

Daniel Wozniak, Ph.D., Chair of Honors Committee

Edgser W. Smith, Department Chair